MEASURE D
CITY OF NEEDLES

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE D

This Impartial Analysis of Measure D has been prepared by the City Attorney pursuant to Section 9280 of the California Elections Code.

The City Council of the City of Needles has placed Measure D on the ballot for the November 3, 2026 General Municipal Election. Measure D would amend Section 503 of the City Charter to increase the compensation paid to each member of the City Council from one dollar ($1.00) per month to one hundred fifty dollars ($150.00) per month.

Effect of Measure on Existing Law:

The City of Needles is a charter city operating under a City Charter adopted by the voters in 1958. Section 503 of the Charter currently provides that each member of the City Council shall receive compensation in the amount of one dollar ($1.00) per month. That amount has remained unchanged since the Charter was adopted approximately sixty-eight years ago.

Because the amount of City Council compensation is established by the City Charter, it may not be changed by ordinance or resolution of the City Council. Under the California Constitution and applicable law governing charter cities, any amendment to the Charter, including a change to City Council compensation, must be approved by the voters.

If approved, Measure D would amend Section 503 of the City Charter to establish compensation for each City Council Member at one hundred fifty dollars ($150.00) per month. The measure would not modify any other provision of Section 503. Existing Charter provisions authorizing reimbursement for actual and necessary travel and other official expenses incurred in the performance of official duties would remain unchanged. The measure would not authorize any additional salary, benefits, or compensation beyond that expressly provided in the Charter.

If approved, the City has determined Measure D would result in an additional annual cost of $20,916 to the City. Pursuant to State law, approval of Measure D requires a majority vote of the City's voters who vote in the election.

If approved, the amendment would become effective following certification of the election results and completion of all procedures required by law for charter amendments.

A "Yes" vote is a vote in favor of amending Section 503 of the City Charter to increase City Council compensation from one dollar ($1.00) per month to one hundred fifty dollars ($150.00) per month.

A "No" vote is a vote against the proposed Charter amendment, and Section 503 of the City Charter would remain unchanged, with City Council compensation continuing at one dollar ($1.00) per month.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure D. If you desire a copy of the Measure, please call the City Clerk's office at (760) 326-2113 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you, or you may obtain a copy by visiting the City's website at www.cityofneedles.com

Lena D. Wade
Deputy City Attorney
City of Needles

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE D

This Argument in Favor of Measure D was submitted pursuant to Section 9282 of the California Elections Code. It is the opinion of the author(s), and has been printed exactly as submitted.

Vote YES on Measure D to modernize an outdated provision of the Needles City Charter and provide reasonable compensation for public service.

When Needles voters adopted the City Charter in 1958, compensation for City Council Members was set at just $1 per month. Sixty-eight years later, that amount has never been changed.

Measure D would update the Charter by establishing compensation of $150 per month for each Council Member. This modest amount recognizes the time, preparation, and responsibility required to serve the residents of Needles while maintaining the principle that service on the City Council is public service, not a full-time salaried position.

Council Members are responsible for studying issues, preparing for and attending public meetings, listening and responding to residents, representing the City, and making important decisions affecting City finances, infrastructure, public services, and the future of our community.

Providing reasonable compensation also helps remove a financial barrier to public service. Residents should have the opportunity to serve their community regardless of whether they can afford to devote substantial time to City business for essentially no compensation.

Measure D is limited and fiscally responsible. It establishes Council compensation at $150 per month while continuing existing provisions for reimbursement of authorized travel and other official expenses. It provides no additional compensation beyond that expressly provided in the Charter.

Based on seven Council Members, the estimated additional cost is **$12,600 per year**.

After 68 years at $1 per month, it is time to update this outdated Charter provision.

Vote YES on Measure D—reasonable compensation for those willing to serve the people of Needles.

s/ Janet Jernigan, Mayor, City of Needles